



**ZERO 1
AWARDS**

DESKTOP CPUs

AGE-OLD BATTLE CONTINUES...

Desktop processors have come a ridiculously long way over 2018. Both AMD and Intel have pushed the envelope this year. CPUs had been Intel's home ground for years before the two companies began competing with each other. The battle's been raging for more than four decades and it seems that AMD has gained significant foothold of, what used to be, Intel's territory. Don't get the wrong idea, Intel still dominates the market in terms of pure sales figures. In the Indian market, Intel has a 90% market share with AMD at 10%. However, AMD gained numbers primarily because the Ryzen and Threadripper CPUs that offer a lot more cores for the same amount. Over the past few months, Intel CPUs have been in short supply and are taking longer to appear in the Indian market leading to AMD getting an ever bigger piece of the pie. This should give you a clear idea about who the winners for this year's Zero1 Awards in the Desktop Processor category will be.

2018 ZERO1 AWARD WINNER AMD Ryzen™ 2nd Gen Threadripper™ 2990WX

Officially, the world's first 32-core HEDT CPU, the Ryzen™ 2nd Gen Threadripper™ 2990WX is an absolute monster of a CPU. It's unlocked as all AMD CPUs are, has a massive 64 MB L3 cache and starts off with a base clock of 3 GHz. The sheer ridiculousness that one experience while benchmarking this CPU is undescrivable. You have to experience it personally. The 2990WX scores more than 5200 in Cinebench R15, that's 800 points over last year's Intel Core i9-7980XE. Should you overclock the 2990WX, you can push the Cinebench R15 scores to 6200! All of this comes at a price of ₹1,29,990. AMD's pricing seems to be more consumer friendly since the 7980XE with 18-cores launched at a higher price. Intel's best HEDT CPU would be



AMD Ryzen™ 2nd Gen Threadripper™ 2990WX

Price: ₹1,29,990

the Core i9-9980XE is yet to reach India but that wasn't going to make a difference. The Ryzen™ 2nd Gen Threadripper™ 2990WX wins this year's Zero1 Award entirely on its own merit.

RUNNER-UP

Ryzen™ 2nd Gen Threadripper™ 2970WX

Sporting six fewer cores, the Ryzen™ 2nd Gen Threadripper™ 2970WX comes in at second place. However, it's not close a close second. The difference in performance metrics between the two SKUs can go as high as 16% in multithreaded applications and even more in certain benchmarks. In single-core performance, the two are equally matched. With a 30K price difference between the two CPUs, the 2970WX seems to be more favourable for folks who wouldn't mind a minor reduction in real world performance in day-to-day applications. For those who are more into getting all the cores into action, the 2990WX is still the better option.



Ryzen™ 2nd Gen Threadripper™ 2970WX

Price: ₹99,990



Intel Core i9-9900K

Price: ₹57,299

EDITOR'S PICK

Intel Core i9-9900K

We picked the Intel Core i9-9900K as the Editor's pick for two simple reasons. It is the best processor for gaming and maintains a lead over its counterparts from AMD. Moreover, its single-core performance is also the highest we have ever seen. The 9th Gen flagship is supposed to be priced at approximately ₹34,000, however, owing to a scarcity of CPUs the world over, the Intel Core i9-9900K can be seen retailing for nearly twice as much. It's a great CPU but not worth the current price at all. 🚩